



The 1970s

The introduction of the “Jumbo Jet” Boeing 747 in 1970 revolutionized commercial air transport as ticket prices fell and the era of mass-market air travel got underway. Fighter planes were routinely flying faster than the speed of sound, and Concorde—introduced in 1976—brought the same performance to the civilian market. Helicopters continued to be a key tool of war, supporting ground troops in Vietnam, while vertical takeoff allowed powerful combat jets to be launched from ocean-going carriers.